

Halo

Zero-Investment Launch Plan

A beautifully designed task manager for everyone — build, monetize with ads, market for free

Build — Monetize with Ads — Market for Free | Working name used in this plan: Halo

SECTION 1

The Strategy in Brief

Halo is a general-purpose task manager built for everyone — no niche targeting, no AI layer. The single differentiator is design quality: animations, theme system, micro-interactions, and typographic polish that make the app feel premium compared to every cluttered free competitor. Beautiful design is shareable by nature — a 15-second screen record of a satisfying completion animation travels on X/LinkedIn/Reels without any marketing budget.

Axis	Decision
Stack	Next.js/React + Capacitor — same codebase for APK and free PWA
Audience	Everyone — no demographic filter, broad appeal
Differentiator	Beautiful design: themes, animations, gestures, micro-interactions
Distribution	GitHub Pages landing page + GitHub Releases APK + Vercel PWA
Monetization	AdMob (banner + interstitial + rewarded) — free to integrate
Marketing	Demo-first: short videos of animations shared on X, LinkedIn, Reels, Reddit

Positioning statement for launch posts: "Halo is the task manager that actually feels good to use — five hand-crafted themes, fluid animations, and swipe gestures. Free forever, no login, works offline."

SECTION 2

Design System — The Core Differentiator

This section is the foundation of the entire plan. Every decision about features, marketing, and distribution depends on the design system being genuinely better than competitors. Build this first, validate it looks polished on a real device, then add functionality.

2.1 Signature Element

The single most memorable interaction in Halo: when you mark a task complete, a soft violet "halo" bloom radiates outward from the checkbox — a 400ms radial glow animation that fades into the background. The task text simultaneously draws a smooth animated strikethrough from left to right (not an instant toggle). Optional: a soft haptic pulse via the Capacitor Haptics plugin so the phone gently vibrates at the moment of completion. This combination — visual bloom + drawn strikethrough + haptic — is the "wow" moment in your demo video and the thing users will mention when sharing the app.

2.2 Color Palette

Token	Hex	Role	Usage
Indigo 600	#4F46E5	Primary accent	Checkboxes, buttons, active tabs, halo glow
Ink 900	#111827	Headings / dark BG	Task titles on light; full BG on Midnight theme
Slate 700	#374151	Body text	Task metadata, descriptions, secondary text
Mint 500	#10B981	Success / done	Completed tasks, streak counter, progress bar fill
Warm white	#FAFAF8	Light surface	Card and page background on light themes
Violet glow	#7C5CFCaa	Halo effect	Radial gradient for completion bloom (with alpha)

2.3 Typography

Role	Font + weight + usage
Display / App name	Outfit Bold (700) — used for app title, list headings, empty-state headlines. Geometric, modern
Task titles	Outfit Medium (500) — strong enough to read on a glance, not heavy enough to feel aggressive
Body / metadata	Inter Regular (400) — due dates, tags, subtask counts. Neutral, highly legible at small sizes.
Completion state	Outfit Medium with CSS strikethrough drawn via SVG animation, text-color shifted to Slate 400
Loading fonts	Both fonts load from Google Fonts CDN (free). Bundle locally if targeting offline-first APK to a

2.4 Five Built-in Themes

Themes are the most shareable design feature. Each theme changes the full color surface, the accent, and optionally the card border-radius. Ship five at launch:

Theme name	Background	Accent	Card surface
Cloud (default)	#FAFAF8 warm white	Indigo #4F46E5	#FFFFFF with 1px RULE border
Midnight	#0F0F1A near-black	Violet #7C5CFC	#1A1A2E dark card
Sakura	#FFF5F7 blush pink	Rose #F43F5E	#FFFFFF with pink tint
Forest	#F0FDF4 pale green	Emerald #059669	#FFFFFF with green tint
Sand	#FEFCE8 warm yellow	Amber #D97706	#FFFBEB with amber tint

Theme switching should animate: a 300ms cross-fade between color surfaces, not a hard cut. Store the selected theme in Capacitor Preferences so it persists between sessions.

2.5 Motion & Micro-interaction Spec

Interaction	Animation spec
Task completion	Halo bloom: 400ms radial violet gradient, opacity 0.6 → 0. Strikethrough: SVG line draws left-
Task add	Card slides in from bottom with spring physics (stiffness 300, damping 28). Do not use a plain
Task delete	Swipe left reveals a red delete zone. Full swipe collapses the card height to 0 over 250ms the
Task complete swipe	Swipe right reveals a green complete zone — triggers the same completion animation as tapp
Theme switch	300ms cross-fade of background and card surface colors using CSS transitions.
Streak milestone	At 7, 30, 100 days — a brief full-screen confetti burst (use canvas-confetti library, 8 KB, free)

2.6 Layout Principles

Keep the core layout clean so the animations land harder. Three rules:

- No more than three UI elements on screen at once per zone: header (app name + date + streak badge), task list (scrollable cards), and a single floating action button (+) to add a task.
- Card padding: 16px top/bottom, 20px left/right. Corner radius: 16px on Cloud/Sakura/Forest/Sand, 8px on Midnight (sharper, edgier mood).
- Bottom navigation bar: Home, Today, Completed, Settings — four tabs only. No hamburger menu, no sidebar.

SECTION 3

Product Plan — What to Build

3.1 Keep from your existing app

- Task creation, editing, deletion
- Due dates and reminders
- Lists / categories / tags
- Completion tracking and history
- Local / offline data storage

3.2 New features to add — v1 (must-have)

Feature	Details
5 built-in themes	See Section 2.4. Theme picker in Settings — the most demo-able feature, include it in every s
Animated task completion	Halo bloom + strikethrough draw + haptic. See Section 2.5. This is the signature moment — b
Swipe gestures	Swipe left to delete (red zone), swipe right to complete (green zone). Standard in premium tas
Spring animations on add/remove	Use Framer Motion (free React library) for spring physics. Install: npm install framer-motion
Streak counter	Home screen shows current consecutive-day streak with a flame icon. Breaks at midnight if z
Today view	A separate tab showing only tasks due today or overdue. Sorted by priority. This is what user
Priority levels	Three levels: High (red dot), Medium (amber dot), Low (grey dot). Colored priority indicator vis
Subtasks	Each task can expand to show a nested list of subtasks. Parent task auto-completes when all

3.3 v2 / nice-to-have (build after launch, based on feedback)

- Pomodoro timer (built-in, 25/5 min with the halo animation on session complete)
- Recurring tasks (daily, weekly, monthly)
- Tags / labels with custom colors
- "Share progress" export — 7-day streak card as an image for WhatsApp status
- Home screen widget (Capacitor supports Android widgets — high-retention feature)
- Custom theme builder (pick your own accent color)

3.4 UX rules that protect the design quality

- No login for v1. A login screen kills the "open it and it just works" feel that design-led apps depend on.
- Onboarding: one screen only — pick a theme. User lands on the task list in 5 seconds. No tours, no tooltips on first launch.
- Keep the APK small. Do not bundle large assets. Use system fonts as fallback if Google Fonts are unavailable.

- No ads on the Today view or during task-completion animation — the halo bloom must never be covered by an ad unit.

SECTION 4

Technical Build Plan

4.1 Why this stack

You already know Next.js/React. Capacitor wraps the web app into a native Android shell, reusing almost all existing code. The same project deploys as a free PWA on Vercel — two distribution channels from one codebase. Framer Motion handles all animations in React with spring physics that feel native, not CSS-janky.

4.2 Step-by-step build sequence

Step	Action
1	Install Framer Motion: npm install framer-motion. Build the halo completion animation first —
2	Build the CSS token system (Section 2.2) as CSS custom properties. Each theme is a class o
3	Add the five themes to a Settings screen with a live preview tile for each. Persist chosen them
4	Add swipe gestures using react-swipeable (free, npm install react-swipeable).
5	Implement the streak counter using Capacitor Preferences to store the last-active date.
6	Configure Next.js static export: output: 'export' in next.config.js.
7	Install Capacitor: npm install @capacitor/core @capacitor/cli, then npx cap init.
8	Add Android: npx cap add android. Install Capacitor Haptics: npm install @capacitor/haptics f
9	Build and sync: npm run build && npx cap sync. Open in Android Studio (npx cap open andro
10	Test on a real device via USB. Check every animation at different frame rates — cheap phone
11	Deploy to Vercel or Cloudflare Pages (free tier) for the PWA version.

4.3 Free tools and libraries

Tool	Purpose / cost
Framer Motion	Spring animations — free, open source, npm install framer-motion
react-swipeable	Swipe gesture detection — free, npm install react-swipeable
canvas-confetti	Streak milestone confetti — free, 8 KB, npm install canvas-confetti
@capacitor/haptics	Haptic feedback on completion — free Capacitor plugin
Outfit + Inter (Google Fonts)	Typography — free CDN or bundle locally
Android Studio	Build and sign the APK — free
Vercel / Cloudflare Pages	Host the PWA — free tier
GitHub	Host code, APK release file, landing page — free

4.4 Offline-first storage

Store all task data using the Capacitor Preferences API or a local SQLite plugin. No backend server, no database costs, works fully offline. The only network calls are Google Fonts (cache after first load) and AdMob ad fetches.

Ad Integration Plan (AdMob)

5.1 Set up AdMob (free)

- Create a Google AdMob account at admob.google.com — free with any Google account.
- Register your app inside AdMob as an Android app (you can do this before any Play Store listing).
- Create three ad units: one Banner, one Interstitial, one Rewarded.
- Note your App ID and each Ad Unit ID — you'll need these in code.
- CRITICAL: use Google's official TEST ad unit IDs during development. Using real IDs before launch, or clicking your own live ads, can permanently ban your AdMob account.

5.2 Integrate with Capacitor

- Install: `npm install @capacitor-community/admob`
- Initialize once at app startup with your AdMob App ID.
- Switch from test IDs to real ad unit IDs only immediately before public launch.

5.3 Placement strategy — protect the design

Ads and beautiful design conflict. The rule: ads only appear where the user is at rest, never mid-interaction and never over an animation.

Ad type	Placement rule
Banner	Bottom of the Home (all tasks) view only. Never on the Today view. Never during or after a co
Interstitial	Only after the user marks all of today's planned tasks complete — a genuine natural break. N
Rewarded (opt-in)	"Watch a short ad to unlock Sand or Forest theme for 48 hours." Opt-in ads generate less frus

5.4 Ad type comparison

Ad type	User friction	India eCPM*	Best placement
Banner	Low	\$0.10 – \$0.50	Persistent footer on Home view only
Interstitial	Medium	\$1 – \$3	After completing all tasks for the day
Rewarded	Low (opt-in)	\$2 – \$5	Unlock theme / temp ad-free

* eCPM ranges are rough industry averages. Actual figures vary by season, ad demand, and traffic quality.

Distribution Plan (Zero Cost)

Channel	Details
GitHub Releases (APK)	Upload the signed APK as a release asset — permanent free download link. Version every re
GitHub Pages (landing page)	One-page site: app name, tagline, 3–4 screenshots showing different themes, demo GIF of th
Vercel / Cloudflare Pages (PWA)	Deploy the same Next.js project. No install friction — users can Add to Home Screen. May gr
F-Droid (optional)	Free listing if you open-source the code. Small audience but tech-literate users who actively o
APKPure / Aptoide	Free developer submission. Some organic search traffic on their own platforms — low-effort e

Marketing & Growth Plan (Zero Budget)

7.1 Core strategy: the demo IS the marketing

A design-led app markets itself through visuals. A 10-second screen recording of the halo bloom animation + theme switcher is more effective than any written description. Every post starts with a clip. Every platform gets a visual-first format.

7.2 Launch content to create (all free)

Content piece	How to create / where to post
15-second demo video	Screen record: add a task → mark it complete (halo animation plays) → switch between all 5
Theme comparison screenshot	Side-by-side of Cloud vs Midnight vs Sakura themes on the same task list. Static image — po
"I built this" launch post	Short build-in-public thread on X/LinkedIn: 3–4 tweets showing the before (plain app) and after
Reel caption template	"Task manager that actually looks good. 5 themes, smooth animations, works offline. Free: [li

7.3 Community channels to target

Platform / community	Approach
r/androidapps	Post the theme screenshot + landing page link. Follow sub rules — frame it as "I built a free a
r/SideProject	"I built a task manager where the differentiator is design — here's the halo animation." This co
r/productivity	Post genuinely: "What makes you actually stick to a task app?" Mention Halo in replies where
r/developersIndia + r/IndianStartups	Build-in-public angle — "Built and shipped a polished Android app for free."
Product Hunt	Free to list. Lead with the animation GIF as the main asset. Design-focused apps do well here
Indie Hackers	Post your launch story including the zero-cost stack. The design-as-differentiator framing is un
X/Twitter + LinkedIn	Build-in-public posts during development ("here's the completion animation I've been working
YouTube Shorts / Instagram Reels	Re-use the 15-second demo clip. "Task app with this animation" thumbnails perform well.

7.4 Outreach message template

"Hey — I built a free task manager that looks and feels different from the usual options. Five hand-crafted themes, a satisfying completion animation, swipe gestures, works offline. No login, no subscription. Would love your honest feedback: [link]"

7.5 Start with your existing network

Message 10–15 people you know and ask them to use it for one week. Specifically ask: "Does the completion animation feel satisfying?" and "Which theme did you end up using daily?" Their answers tell you whether the design hook is landing. This is your real data before you post anywhere public.

8-Week Timeline

Week	Focus	Key output	
1–2	Design foundation	CSS token system, 5 themes, halo animation, spring card add/remove	
3	Full feature build	Swipe gestures, streak counter, Today view, priority dots, subtasks	
4	Capacitor + haptics	First working APK with haptic feedback, tested on real device	
5	Ad integration	AdMob banner + interstitial + rewarded in correct placements with test IDs	
6	Distribution setup	Landing page live, PWA deployed, 10–15 peer testers using the app	
7	Feedback pass	Fix bugs from peer testing, polish animations on low-end devices	
8	Public launch	Switch to live AdMob IDs, Product Hunt launch, post demo video across channels	

After launch: post one piece of content per week minimum (a new screenshot, a build-in-public update, a reply in [r/productivity](#)). Consistent posting matters more than launch-day volume.

SECTION 9

Realistic Revenue Projections

Rough math: at approximately \$1 blended eCPM and 3 ad impressions per active user per day, 1,000 daily active users generates roughly \$3/day — around Rs. 7,500/month. Reaching Rs. 50,000/month from ads requires approximately 6,000–7,000 daily active users.

The design hook mainly helps the top of the funnel — the demo video drives installs. Retention (daily open rate) is what converts installs into ad revenue, and that depends on whether the Today view and streak counter bring users back each morning. Beautiful design reduces uninstall rate compared to generic apps — that is the real compounding advantage of the design-led approach.

Realistic month 1–2 expectation: low hundreds of installs from your network and community posts, near-zero to a few hundred rupees in ad revenue. Treat this phase as validation — are people opening the app daily and maintaining streaks? Revenue follows retained daily users, not install counts.

Track the PWA/website version separately from the APK. Because it has zero install friction, it may grow faster initially and is worth comparing. AdMob serves ads in the PWA too, so both channels contribute revenue.

SECTION 10

Pre-Launch Checklist

01. All 5 themes implemented, tested on light and dark mode, theme persists between sessions
02. Halo bloom + drawn strikethrough + haptic fire correctly on task completion
03. Spring card animation plays on task add; card collapses cleanly on delete
04. Swipe left to delete and swipe right to complete work reliably
05. Streak counter increments correctly and milestone animation fires at 7 / 30 / 100 days
06. Today view shows only due-today and overdue tasks, sorted by priority
07. Subtasks expand and parent auto-completes when all subtasks are done
08. APK builds and installs correctly on a real device (test a budget Android phone if possible)
09. Animations are smooth on a low-end device — add reduced-motion fallbacks if needed
10. AdMob banner, interstitial, and rewarded integrated and tested with Google TEST ad IDs
11. Banner does NOT appear on Today view or during / immediately after completion animation
12. Landing page live on GitHub Pages with 3–4 screenshots, demo GIF, and working APK download link
13. PWA deployed on Vercel/Cloudflare Pages and "Add to Home Screen" tested on a phone

14. 15-second demo video recorded showing: add task → completion animation → theme switcher
15. 10+ peer testers given the app with specific questions about animation feel and theme preference
16. Product Hunt listing drafted with animation GIF as the lead asset
17. 3–5 target communities identified with self-promotion rules checked
18. Switched from AdMob TEST ad unit IDs to real ad unit IDs immediately before public launch